Joined the Indian Police Service in 1972 (the first woman officer in India to do so). Performed various assignments, notable among them being the following: (1) District Police, Delhi Traffic Police during the Ninth Asian Games in Delhi; (2) Special Traffic Police in Goa during Commonwealth Heads of Government Meet; (3) deputy director Narcotics Control Bureau; (4) deputy inspector general (range) Mizoram; (5) inspector general of prisons, Tihar Jail, New Delhi; (6) special secretary to the lieutenant governor of Delhi; (7) joint commissioner, Delhi Police; (8) inspector general of police, Chandigarh; (9) joint commissioner of police (training), Delhi Police; (10) special commissioner (intelligence), Delhi Police; (11) civilian police adviser to the secretary-general, UN, in the Department of Peacekeeping Operations; (12) DG Home Guards and Civil Defence; and (13) DG BRPD.

Decorations/Awards

National

- Received the Police Medal for Gallantry from the president of India (1979)
- Received an International Award from Association of Christian Colleges and Universities: International Ecumenical Forum (ACCU-IEF) for promotion of quality of life through the campaign against alcohol, drugs, AIDS and tobacco (September 1998)
- Conferred the first ever IIT-Delhi Alumni Association 1999–2000 Award for outstanding contribution to national development
- Conferred the Mother Teresa Award for Social Justice (2005)
- Received the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI) Award (2005)
- Received an award for transformative leadership in the Indian Police Service (2006)
- Received the Suryadatta National Award (2007)
- Declared the Amity Woman Achiever for Social Justice (2007)
- Received the Public Service Excellence Award (2007)
- Received the Zee Astitva Award (2007)
- Received the Baba Farid Award (2007)
- Received an award from the Indian Society of Criminology (2008)
- Received the Pride of Punjab Award (2008)
- Received a Lifetime Achievement Award from the Bank of Baroda (2008)